

63.7 THE ZERO ARTICLE

An article is not needed with uncountable and plural nouns used in a general context. This is known as the zero article.

I don't like the beach.
I get **sand** everywhere.

Uncountable noun.

Plural noun.



You can see **famous sights** all over New York City.



The zero article is also used with some places and institutions when it is clear what their purpose is.

Liz is seven. She goes **to school** now.

She goes there to study, which is the purpose of schools, so no article is used.



Larry works at **the school** in Park Street.

The definite article is used to talk about the specific school where he works.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Coffee is one of Colombia's major exports.



Kangaroos are common in Australia.



I am studying Engineering **in college** in Chicago.



Liz goes **to school** at 8am.



In the UK, **children** start school when they are five years old.



I've got so many **books**.



Paris is the capital of France.

Names of places often take the zero article.



Go **to bed**, Tom!

